

offer an improved benefit to all employees, including me. I spent next to nothing educating myself on investing.

Do you think that adds value to a company? Could you do something similar to help your company?

If you want to be paid more, make yourself more valuable. You need to be proactive, seek ways to add value and develop a skill set. But sometimes that's still not enough. ESI emphasized that while you need to start by focusing on the things you can control, you should expand your sphere of influence to areas that others think they can't control. You not only need to manage your career, you have to learn to manage your boss.

Manage Your Boss

The phrase "manage your boss" sounds a bit manipulative and nefarious. But ESI's advice came from a person who was "the boss." He's managed hundreds of employees in his career, loved employees who did this, and recommends you utilize this technique to grow your income.

Those who do more than expected and add value tend to reap the rewards with larger raises, bigger bonuses, and faster career growth. But it's not enough to just work harder. You need to understand what